

From Objectives to Analysis: Turning Questions into Actionable Plans

Business Objectives vs. Analysis Goals

Why This Matters



Data alone doesn't solve problems—clarity of purpose does



Many projects fail due to poorly framed questions



Understanding the business context ensures analytics delivers value

Business Objectives vs. Analysis Goals

Business objective:
"Increase season ticket renewals by 10%"

Analysis goal: "Identify characteristics of past renewers vs. non-renewers"

Business Objective	Analysis Goal
What the organization wants to achieve	What the analyst must uncover or measure
Strategic, high-level, value-driven	Tactical, measurable, data-driven
Examples: Increase revenue, reduce churn	Examples: Identify churn predictors, segment customers



Turning Objectives into Questions

Good questions are specific, measurable, decision-relevant

Types of questions:

Descriptive: What happened?

Diagnostic: Why did it happen?

Predictive: What will happen next?

Prescriptive: What should we do about it?

Example: "What factors most influence customer renewal?"

From Question to Analysis Plan

Framework:	Example Walkthrough:
1. Clarify the Question	Question: "What factors predict whether someone will renew their season ticket?"
2. Define the Outcome Variable	Outcome: Renewed (yes/no)
3. Identify the Relevant Data	Data: Customer demographics, past attendance, digital engagement
4. Choose Analysis Techniques	Technique: Logistic regression or decision tree
5. Specify Success Criteria	Success: Model predicts with 70%+ accuracy



Practice Scenario

Scenario: A regional grocery chain wants to increase customer retention.

1. Business
Objective?

2. Business
Question?

3. Analysis
Goal?

4. Needed
Data?

What are your thoughts?

Recap & Key Takeaways



1. Business objectives = Why. Analysis goals = How.



2. Clear, actionable questions make analysis relevant.



3. Plans should be structured around the question, outcome, and data.

Closing Thought: "An analyst bridges the gap between business needs and data insights."